Curriculum Vitae

ERICA NIEMIEC SKELTON

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EDUCATION

2024-2029 **Doctor of Philosophy** (expected)
Psychology, Northeastern University, Boston, MA

2026 **Master of Science**
Psychology, Northeastern University, Boston, MA

2022 **Post-baccalaureate Certificate**
Graduate Foundations in Psychology, Columbia University, New York, NY

2009 **Bachelor of Arts**
Classical Civilization, Latin, with Honors, University of Minnesota Twin Cities, Minneapolis, MN

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024-present **Graduate Student Researcher**, Learning and Brain Development Laboratory
Northeastern University
Advisor: Dr. Juliet Davidow
Research Focus: Development of neural systems supporting reward-related learning and goal-directed behavior; influence of social and prosocial motivations on risky decision-making; computational modeling and neuroimaging methods

2022-2024 **Lab Manager,** Developmental Affective Neuroscience Laboratory
Columbia University
Advisor: Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Adaptations in executive function following caregiving-related early-life adversity; resilience through emotion regulation following severe early-life adversity; longitudinal development and neuroimaging methods

2020-2022 **Research Assistant**, Developmental Affective Neuroscience Laboratory
Columbia University
Advisor: Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Cognitive and affective development following caregiving-related early-life adversity

Summer 2021 **Research Intern,** Summer Internship Program in Psychological Science
Columbia University
Advisors: Anna Vannucci, Dr. Nim Tottenham
Research Focus: Associations between mentorship and anxious behaviors in children with heterogeneous early caregiving experiences

WORK EXPERIENCE

2013-2022 **Student Services Manager**, Brownsville Middle School
Achievement First

2009-2011 **Mathematics Teacher**, Ruleville Central High School
Teach for America

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Manuscripts:

1. **Niemiec, E.,** Fields, A., Vannucci, A., Abramson, L.A., Bloom, P.A., Camacho, N.L., Choy, T., Durazi, A., Gibson, L., Hadis, S.H., Harmon, C., Heleniak, C., Umbach, R., VanTieghem, M., Dozier, M., Milham, M.P., & Tottenham, N. Adolescent-specific adaptations to caregiving unpredictability: a longitudinal examination of cognitive flexibility. *Developmental Psychology* (2026). https://doi.org/ 10.1037/dev0002168

2. **Niemiec, E**., Insel, C., & Davidow, J.Y. Striatal and hippocampal contributions to value-based learning in adolescence. *Neuropsychopharmacology* 51, 129–135 (2026). https://doi.org/10.1038/s41386-025-02260-7

3. Abramson, L.*, Vannucci, A.*, Vicioso, C., Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. Caregiving-related early adversities and parental context effects on adolescents' momentary emotion differentiation. *Development and Psychopathology* (2026). https://doi.org/10.1017/S0954579426102119
** denotes shared first authorship*

4. Yates, T., Sigwebela, S., Seedat, S., Milham, M., du Plessis, S., Abramson, L., **Niemiec, E.,** Worthman, C., Rotheram-Borus, M. J., Salum, G., Franco, A., Zuanazzi, A., Ahmed, F., Gemmell, K., Christodoulou, J., Mhlaba, N., Mqhele, N., Ngalimane, N., Sambudla, A., Tottenham, N., Tomlinson, M. Investigative approaches to resilient emotion regulation development in a South African birth cohort. *Biological Psychiatry Global Open Science*, 100457 (2025). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.bpsgos.2025.100457

Under Review and In Preparation:

1. Worthman, Carol M., Sigwebela, S., Gemmell, K., Mhlaba, N., Mqhele, N., Ngalimane, N., Sambudla, A., Yates, T., Abramson, L., **Niemiec, E**., du Plessis, S., Ahmed, F., Salum, G., Zuanazzi, A., Christodoulou, J., Franco, A., Rotheram Borus, M. J., Milham, M., Seedat, S., Tottenham, N., Tomlinson, M. Evolving cultural adaptation in developmental science: principles, processes, and people. Under review: *Developmental Psychology*

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

1. **Niemiec, E.**, van Rijn, R., Hennessy, R. R., Olafsson, V., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., Aubrey, B. M., Hegefeld, H. M., Morfini, F., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., Braams, B. R.*, Davidow, J. Y.* For the greater good: Mapping the neural underpinnings of prosocial risk-taking with multimodal MRI. Poster to be presented at: Cognitive Neuroscience Society; March, 2027; Boston, Massachusetts.

2. Aubrey, B. M., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., **Niemiec, E.**, Hegefeld, H. M., Olafsson, V., Morfini, F., Hennessy, R. R., Loui, P., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., & Davidow, J. Y. Associations between age and iron in brain tissue across adolescence. Poster to be presented at: Cognitive Neuroscience Society; March, 2027; Boston, Massachusetts.

3. **Niemiec, E.**, van Rijn, R., Hennessy, R. R., Olafsson, V., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., Aubrey, B. M., Hegefeld, H. M., Morfini, F., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., Braams, B. R.*, Davidow, J. Y.* Associations between prosocial risk-taking and striatal tissue iron: an exploratory analysis in adolescents. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.
   * *denotes equal contribution*

4. Aubrey, B. M., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., **Niemiec, E.**, Hegefeld, H. M., Olafsson, V., Morfini, F., Hennessy, R. R., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., & Davidow, J. Y. Associations between motivated learning and iron in brain tissue across adolescence. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.

5. Juarez, D. G., Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P. A., Camacho, N., **Niemiec, E.,** Gibson, L., Hadis, S., Heleniak, C., Milham, M. P., & Tottenham, N. Reduced fear generalization is associated with amygdala differentiation and is modulated by early caregiving experiences. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.

6. Joyce, E., Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P.A., Camacho, N., Choy, T., Durazi, A., Hadis, S., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Heleniak, C., Harmon, C., Van Tieghem, M., Abramson, L., Dozier, M., Milham, M.P., Tottenham, N. Poor inhibitory control following early caregiving adversity is associated with divergent prefrontal cortex development in adolescence: a longitudinal fMRI study. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.

7. Morfini, F., Murch, G., Pidvirny, K., Jaffe, N., Olafsson, V., **Niemiec, E.,** Aubrey, B.M., Whitfield-Gabrieli, S., Auerbach, R.P., Davidow, J.Y., Webb, C.A. Selective association of ventral striatum brain-tissue iron with anhedonia in adolescents at risk for depression. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2026; La Jolla, California.

8. Vannucci, A., Yates, T.S., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D., Joyce, E., **Niemiec, E.**, Fields, A., Heleniak, C., Gibson, L., Milham, M.P., Baldassano, C., Tottenham, N. Neural

representations of ambiguous social-emotional events in adolescents vary by early caregiving experience. In Meyer, M.L. (chair), Future Directions in Social Learning and Memory [Symposium]. Paper presented at: Social Affective Neuroscience Society; April, 2026; San Diego, CA.

9. Aubrey, B. M., Kathios, N., Lopez, K. L., **Niemiec, E.**, Hegefeld, H. M., Olafsson, V., Morfini, F., Hennessy, R. R., Gabard-Durnam, L. J., Loui, P., Davidow, J. Y. Associations between motivated learning and iron in brain tissue across adolescence. Poster accepted, not presented due to health reasons: Cognitive Neuroscience Society; March, 2026, Vancouver, BC, Canada.

10. Vannucci, A., DiGiovanni, A., Abramson, L., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D., Joyce, E., **Niemiec, E.**, Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. Alterations in parent-adolescent negative-affect linkage in the real-world following early caregiving adversity. In Abramson, L. (chair), Interpersonal mechanisms linking parent-child interactions, emotional expertise, and adolescents' mental health [Symposium]. Paper presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2026; Pittsburg, PA.

11. **Niemiec, E.,** Jain, K., Hennessy, R., Davidow, J.Y. Adolescent risky goal-directed behavior: Introducing CatSnax, a novel behavioral paradigm examining (pro)social and altruistic risky actions. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2025; Dublin, Ireland.

12. Vannucci, A., Fields, A., Bloom, P.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Heleniak, C., Gibson, L., Hadis, S.S., Camacho, N.L., Durazi, A., Choy, T., VanTieghem, M., Milham, M.P.*, Tottenham, N.* Longitudinal evidence of altered frontostriatal inhibitory control development following caregiving-related early adversity. Poster presented at: Flux International Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2025; Dublin, Ireland. *these senior authors contributed equally to this work

13. Abramson Vaisman, L., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E**., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Early caregiving adversity mitigates later associations between parental contexts and adolescents' momentary emotion granularity. Poster presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2025; Portland, OR.

14. Vannucci, A., Yates, T.S., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E**., Juarez, D.G., Joyce, E., Gibs on, L., Milham, M.P., Baldassano, C., Tottenham, N. Neural representations of shared attachment schemas in adolescents following caregiving related early adversity. Poster presented at: Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2024; Baltimore, MD.

15. Gavrilova, N., Bloom, Paul A., **Niemiec, E.**, Vannucci, A., Camacho, N. L., Choy, T., Heleniak, C., Hadis, S., Gibson, L., Fields, A., Harmon, C., Tottenham, N. Longitudinal associations between executive function and anxiety in youth exposed to heterogeneous caregiving-related early adversities. Poster presented at: Teachers College Institute of Psychological Science and Practice Conference; April, 2024; New York, NY.

16. Abramson, L., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E.,** Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. Adolescents' momentary emotion differentiation varies by social context and caregiving history. Poster presented at: Society for Affective Science; March, 2024; New Orleans, LA.

17. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Joyce, E., Juarez, D. G., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Parental unpredictability is associated with broader medial prefrontal-subcortical circuitry recruitment during affective schema processing in human development. Poster presented at: Society for Neuroscience; November, 2023; Washington, DC.

18. Abramson, L., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Juarez, D.G., Fields, A., **Niemiec, E**., Gibson, L., Bolger, N., Tottenham, N. The development of emotion differentiation following early caregiving adversities. Poster presented at: Developmental Affective Neuroscience Symposium; November, 2023; Pittsburgh, PA.

19. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.,** Juarez, D.G., Joyce ,E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Neural meaning making of early caregiving experiences: the developmental neurobiology of affective semantic memory. Poster presented at: Federation of European Neuroscience Societies (FENS) Brain Conference on Structuring Knowledge for Flexible Behavior; October, 2023; Rungsted Kyst, Denmark.

20. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L. A, **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Midline cortico-amygdala circuitry supports affective semantic memory processes during development. Poster presented at: Flux Congress for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience; September, 2023; Santa Rosa, California.

21. Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Fields, A., Abramson, L.A., **Niemiec, E.**, Juarez, D. G., Joyce, E., Gibson, L., Tottenham, N. Neural meaning making of early caregiving experiences: the developmental neurobiology of affective semantic memory. Paper presented at: International Society for Developmental Psychobiology; July, 2023; Utrecht, Netherlands.

22. **Niemiec, E**., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Tottenham, N. Non-parental adult mentorship and anxious behaviors in school-age children with and without caregiving-related early adversities: support for the developmental match/mismatch hypothesis. Virtual Poster presented at: Harvard Women in Psychology Trends in Psychology; November, 2021.

23. **Niemiec, E**., Vannucci, A., Vicioso, C., Tottenham, N. Mentorship and the developing mind: links to anxious behaviors in children with early caregiving adversities. Virtual Data Blitz presentation at: Summer Internship Program in Psychological Science; August, 2021.

24. **Niemiec, E.**, Clayton, T.S. *Saeva modesta:* The Tacitean Female in Shakespeare's *Titus Andronicus*. Paper presented at: Miami University Undergraduate Classics Conference; March, 2009; Oxford, Ohio.

AWARDS & HONORS

2009	*Magna cum Laude*, University of Minnesota Twin Cities
2008-2009	Top Five Female Student Athlete, University of Minnesota Twin Cities
2006-2009	Collegiate Rowing Coaches Association Scholar Athlete
2006-2009	Big Ten Academic All-Conference Team Member
2005-2009	Dean's List, University of Minnesota Twin Cities

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT & OUTREACH

2026	How does the developing brain support learning from rewards? post in PsychPress: Graduate Voices in Science blog
2026-present	Vice President, Graduate Student Association, Psychology Department, Northeastern University
2026-present	Graduate School Mentoring Program, Northeastern University, Mentor
2026-present	College of Science Student Diversity Advisory Council Mentoring Program
2025-present	Graduate Student Association Organizing Committee (Resources), Psychology Department, Northeastern University
2025-present	Northeastern University Community Liaisons for Education Using STEM (NUCLEUS)
2025-present	Letters to a Pre-Scientist STEM Pen-Pal
2025-2026	NSF Young Scholars' Program Mentor, Northeastern University
2026	"Stress and the Adolescent Brain: Challenges and Advantages of a Growing Brain" presentation at Boston Latin Academy, Boston, MA
2025	"Adolescent Learning and Goal Directed Behavior" presentation at Boston College, Boston, MA, NSF-sponsored high school outreach event
2025	"What It's Like to Be a Brain Researcher" presentation at Boston Latin Academy, Boston, MA
2025	Graduate School Mentoring Program, Northeastern University, Volunteer Speaker
2024	Application Statement Feedback Program (ASFP) Volunteer Editor
2024	Girls Science Day Volunteer, Columbia University, New York, NY
2023	Genspace and Apex for Youth Brain Awareness Mini-Carnival Volunteer, New York, NY
2023	MindBoggling Exhibit Volunteer, The School At Columbia Science Expo, New York, NY
2021	Co-Mentor, BRAINYAC Program

MEMBERSHIPS IN PROFESSIONAL AND SCIENTIFIC SOCIETIES

2026-present	Society for Philosophy and Neuroscience
2026-present	International Society for Moral Psychology
2025-present	Flux Society for Developmental Cognitive Neuroscience
2025-present	Cognitive Neuroscience Society
2025-present	Boston Area Neuroscience Group

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Neuroimaging: fMRI acquisition and preprocessing, FSL, Freesurfer, BIDS formatting
Programming languages and statistical analysis: R, Python, SPSS
Data collection tools: PsychoPy, REDCap, Qualtrics, Gorilla, E-Prime
Open Science: GitHub, OSF
Certifications: Level 3 functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI), HIPAA/CITI